

Chapter 5

Night enveloped the flat and there was not a sound to startle the otter awake, yet he shuddered into wakefulness anyway. Sitting bolt upright in bed, he thrust the duvet away from his chest, eyes wide and staring as his heart thudded like a runaway train. Sweat matted the fur across his forehead and he swiped the back of his paw across in a futile attempt to wipe the moisture away. It was always a trial to get sweat out of fur without soaking it further, one of the reasons why he had a fur drier on his 'to buy' list. You know, when he was rich and all that. Even if his state of half-sleep resetting himself in the waking world, Liam chuckled shakily. How daft he could be.

And, in the darkness, some things could seem all too real.

It had been a dream, nothing but a dream, he told himself, shakily reaching for a non-existent glass of water on his bedside table. To his annoyance, however, he had forgotten to grab it while Darren had been over, the wolf collapsing into sleep in the early hours of the morning after the NHL game. Liam trembled. The wolf was sprawled on *his* sofa and all his bravery had deserted him in the dead of the night. He had been brave enough for one day and the next day did not yet count, as far as he was concerned.

He flopped back on to the bed and reached his arms behind his head, biceps flexing as his elbows pointed straight up towards the headboard. His whiskers twitched as he took long, deep breaths to calm himself, counting each heartbeat as it thrummed in his chest. Slowly, his heartbeat slowed its frantic pounding and he returned to a stronger sense of himself, tail flipping idly beneath the bed covers. Staring up at the ceiling with the peeling paint just visible in the gloom, Liam considered what had made him so manic in the first place: the dream.

It had not been a bad dream. It had been a very good dream. It had been a dream that set his heart racing and breath coming in short, breathy gasps, interspaced with a select moan or two. All for a certain wolf.

Liam gulped. How could he have a dream like that when Darren was sleeping in the next room? The wolf groaning as Liam thrust into his...no. What if he had said something in his sleep and the wolf had heard him? Others at camp and sleepovers had told him before that he was prone to sleep talking – what if he still did it? Liam quailed, closing his eyes. What if he had...moaned?

The otter shrank down into the bed, finding no reason in his mind to be brave when there was no one there to bear witness. He had done enough. Sometimes it was easier to be weaker and what was truly wrong with taking the weaker route from time to time anyway? Turning his muzzle into the pillows, the otter shook and whimpered softly, burying his muzzle beneath so that he would not be heard.

Despite his worries about being heard, Liam's paw crept down his chest to his lower abdomen, daring lower. He scratched his fingers lightly the fur on his abdomen, rudder twitching. As clear as the bedroom taking shape before his eyes as they adjusted to the dark, he felt his body tense, muscles drawing taut lines beneath his fur. In his mind's eye, he saw the wolf pushing open the bedroom door, bare but for his fur. He shivered, fingers curling,

and watched as Darren licked his lips, stepped over the threshold and stretched his arms over his head, muscles flexing. The otter bit his lip, a low rumble building in his chest.

As he shook his head, trying to dispel the thoughts, another part of his body reacted. His cock throbbed, swelling with blood, and tented up through his underwear and the heavier duvet, a small bump that could easily be explained away but not denied. Liam rolled his eyes at himself and bodily tossed himself on to his side, making the bed bend and creak in the middle as it protested his treatment: it would not stand up to much more if he continued to throw about even his lithe form.

Pushing his muzzle into the pillow, the otter groaned and willed his cock to go down, slip back into its sheath and let him forget the image of a shirtless wolf, perhaps even a shirtless wolf with one paw down his pants...

No!

Liam could have laughed at himself, only clapping a paw over his lips in the nick of time so that he would not draw attention to himself. He was a pervert, really, to be so caught up in thinking about a guy when the poor dude was likely straight and, well, sleeping in the next bleeding room! Rubbing between his ears, the otter blinked up at the ceiling, feeling sleep suddenly very far off despite the tiredness ringing through his skull. Outside, a car horn blared, a long hold on the horn from some irritated fur or another.

Could he? What if he...liked the wolf? Could he say that? Was it too soon? What was wrong with his head?

His shaft pulsed a globule of pre cum, ignorant to his wishes to soften, to be sensible and go back to sleep, as the tip nudged out the top of his boxer briefs, over the band. The otter squirmed, body twisting into the sheets as lights from a car swinging about the car park glanced across the ceiling. He should have bought better curtains while he had had the chance, some spare coin in his pocket. And yet his shaft demanded attention, a rigid, fleshy-pink rod. Aching to be touched, even the soft brush of cotton that really could have done with a wash a couple of days ago was too much and the otter stifled a moan as his cock pressed into the yielding mattress.

This is stupid, he thought, tongue snaking out to anxiously lap over his lips, suddenly too dry for comfort. *There's someone else here. Darren is here. Stop this!*

But he would not be stopped. Liam's traitorous paw continued to move, squeezing the hardening shaft in his boxer-briefs as they quickly became too constricting for any semblance of comfort. With a half-muffled groan, he tugged them down and yanked them off his hind paws with a quick twist of his body in a demonstration of typical otter flexibility that only a few species seemed able to rival. His undergarments landed on the floor, kicked by a wayward hind paw, and he relaxed on his back, pushing the duvet down to his knees, heartbeat fluttering in his throat.

Wrapping a paw around the base of his cock, he moaned and then smacked himself in the muzzle, remembering a moment too late his need to be quiet. Heart pounding, he shot up in a flurry of sheets and propped himself up on one paw as he listened for any sound, anything at all, coming from the other side of the door. Had Darren heard? Had he been too loud? Was

the wolf about to burst through the door and demand to know what he'd been doing? Would it be that hard to work out?

His cock ached.

A raucous laugh echoed, bouncing off the walls, and Liam jumped, scrabbling to bring his paws beneath his body before his mind caught up with his nerves. A drunk. A fur outside. Outside his flat. In the car park. Nothing to worry about. He pressed his paw to his chest, eyes wide and unblinking. In the living room, Darren rolled out a snore, compounding the fact that he was, in fact, safely asleep. It was a wonder that the drunk laughing at his own idiocy had not driven himself straight to the land of the waking.

Heart pounding, he lowered himself back to the bed as if it would suddenly clamp shut around him and tried to calm the old dragon licking at the corners of his mind. At least he was a familiar beast, if undesired and ultimately unwelcome.

"Easy now," he told himself in as quiet a whisper as he could manage, falling back on old coping mechanisms to soothe his frazzled nerves. "It's just some drunk fur outside, you're all right. Calm down... Please, please, come on now, you have to calm down, just a little bit. No stress, no stress at all here, nothing to worry about."

Silly words, cubbish words, simple words, but they were all he had in the moment when the world spun sickeningly around him, gut churning as if he'd run a marathon and was about to lose his stomach. It would be okay as long as he could get himself to calm down. Sweat dampened the fur beneath his arms and Liam gnawed the inside of his cheek until it bled, blood spilling metallic on to his tongue and seeping in a minute river between his teeth.

What a stupid idea it had been to get off when Darren slept in the next room. He knew how wound up he could get – and not in the good way! Never before had he had another fur sleep in his sad little flat and never before in this particular home had he had to worry about someone hearing him, well...paw off. Get off. Whatever he wanted to call it – he hadn't had to worry about it since he'd lived with his parents. Liam closed his eyes, staring at the speckled inside of his eyelids, glimmers of eerie light showing through in a world that could not be described with known colours.

Oddly, the closing of his eyes was calming and he took several slow, deep breaths, concentrating on drawing each one out for the longest span of time he thought possible. His heartbeat slowed in time, matching the flow of oxygen and expelling of carbon dioxide as his paw tentatively rose to his cock again in a light brushing of fingertips. It seemed to rise to his touch, though he knew in the back of his mind that it was only the incremental movement of his body. Yet if there was one thing that would help him relax... The otter smiled. It was scientifically proven, after all.

He strove to forget the pounding of his heart as his paw squeezed and moved down the length of his cock, tugging the skin taut. It was exactly what he needed and he released a sigh as he pumped his length, collecting pre cum on the palm of his paw for a sliver of lubrication that was helpful if not entirely needed for a quickie. The shaft bragged a slight bend that a previous partner – one of only two that Liam had had in his young lifetime – had liked to comment on repeatedly, thinking it a flaw. The otter thrust the thought from his mind. The cat hadn't been much of a boyfriend. And the shape of his cock didn't matter either. Every fur

was different, after all, so there really was no normal anymore. He had better things to occupy his mind with.

His fantasy of the wolf came more swiftly this time and his mind-wolf strode into the bedroom with a calm, worldly demeanour. His smile spread easily across his long muzzle and he dropped lightly on to the bed atop Liam, putting them muzzle to muzzle. Not saying a word, Darren dipped his muzzle to the otter's neck and graced it with a brush of sharp teeth teasing through fur, though not hard enough to draw blood – just a nibble. A love nibble.

Panting, Liam gasped as his paw worked harder and he imagined the wolf kissing a line down his chest and stomach, directly to the tapered point of his cock. It wasn't as if a fantasy required much foreplay. A smile quirked up Liam's lips. He had all the mental material he needed to get going already. In his mind, Darren winked up at him and took his cock between his lips, tail wagging as he engulfed the hard flesh down to the base, lips pursed into a firm 'O'. He sucked, paws stroking Liam's belly, and bobbed his head, long muzzle proving ideal for a blowjob that made the otter weak at his knees, thankful to be laying on the bed.

In reality, however, he was sprawled on his bed and his weak knees were a result of his imaginings only while the object of his attention slumbered only a few metres away, if as the crow flies. His paw worked quickly, stroking his length to get himself to his peak quickly as only he knew his body, and he arched up from the bed, on the brink of orgasm. He grasped his dream-wolf's ears and thrust up from the bed into his muzzle, holding his breath as his hips juddered. The otter rolled his head back as orgasm claimed him and he spurted cum over his thighs and abdomen, staining his brown fur with milky-white streaks of evidence. But in his mind, Darren gulped down every drop, fluffy tail wagging as if he was happy to be in the position he was.

Oh, how Liam wished.

Cum streaked his fur and he dropped his paw from his cock when it became too sensitive in the immediate aftermath of orgasm, pleasure tingling down to his toes as his whole body relaxed. The duvet had somehow ended up on the floor and he was dimly aware of another fur laughing outside his window, talking too loudly on a mobile phone, though he no longer found it in himself to care. Did it matter if someone was outside? They wouldn't have heard anything. He had been as quiet as a mouse! Reality had to be returned to sooner or later, on the other paw.

Panting for breath, Liam stretched out on his messed up bed, one paw clapped over his muzzle as he strove to quiet the sound of his breath, heavy gasps drawing much needed oxygen back into his lungs. His heart rate, on the other paw, now beat more naturally and he could count that dodging of a figurative bullet a success indeed. Liam chirped into his paw, eyes shining though his eyelids drooped, heavy with sleep so far denied.

Nicely done, otter.

The morning was going to be an interesting one indeed. The otter chanced a grin in a flash of white teeth before quelling it again, eyes cast down to his throbbing, softening cock where it lay across his thigh, cum still drooling from the tip. He had never been so productive. Just what had gotten into him? Blushing, he ran a paw through the trail of cum, scooped up what he could from his fur and brought his paw up to his muzzle. He only hesitated for the briefest

of seconds before lapping off the salty concoction, eyes half-closed as he imagined that it was not himself he was tasting.

As he cleaned up his mess the best he could, listening to Darren's snore echoing through from the living room, the otter nipped the inside of his cheek and considered the implications of what he did not want to acknowledge. He was attracted to the wolf, that much was crystal clear, but what did he want to do about it? Should he raise it with Darren? Was Darren even interested in males? Liam's lips twisted. The wolf had not mentioned that he was dating anyone but he could be a funny type, perhaps, one of those that liked to keep their private, dating lives completely separate to everything else. They were always the hardest to suss out in the early days.

Would Darren want anything to do with him even if he did swing that way? Liam shook his head and screwed up the towel he had been using to wipe up his cum, tossing it beside the bed. He would sneak it into the washing machine in the morning or after Darren had left, providing the smell was not too strong. Almost wishing that the wolf had caught him – it would make everything so much simpler, black and white, right or wrong – the otter scratched his shoulder, banishing unwelcome thoughts. They were not something that he had the present capacity to deal with.

Liam sighed and crawled back into bed, diving under the covers as if to hide from the world and the reality that he would have to face at some point. But not tonight.

He really should get some sleep.